

Sunday, 26 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Heavy drizzle

25° 19°

BIRMINGHAM

Light rain

20° 15°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

19° 15°

GLASGOW

Light rain

18° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 Six men have been arrested after a fatal stabbing in south London early on Saturday morning.**
Police were called to Tremadoc Road where a man was found with stab wounds. He was sadly pronounced dead at the scene.
CRIME · UK
- 2 Murder arrests have also been made in Luton, after a teenager died following a stabbing.**
The 17-year-old was taken to hospital with multiple stab wounds but sadly died shortly afterwards. Investigations are ongoing.
CRIME · UK
- 3 After a slightly cooler spell, heatwave conditions are set to return for many parts of the UK, with temperatures potentially hitting 35 degrees Celsius.**
While some areas may see a welcome bit of rain this weekend, it won't be enough to break the dry spell. Get ready to feel the heat again!
WEATHER · UK
- 4 A hidden world of illegal hare hunts, violence and dumped dead animals has been exposed across the UK.**
Farmers are describing attacks and police have received thousands of reports of banned hare coursing. It's a shocking insight into a brutal underground activity.
CRIME · UK
- 5 A law student has been charged after a bomb was reportedly intercepted in a car she was driving.**
Her lawyer claims she had no knowledge that a bag in the vehicle contained an explosive device. The case is now proceeding through the courts.
CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 **Letters written by a young Morrissey, before he found fame with The Smiths, are set to go up for auction.**

The fascinating collection of letters were sent to a Birmingham pen pal when the singer was between 14 and 20 years old. They offer a unique glimpse into his early life and thoughts.

ON AIR – What do you think a young Morrissey would have been like as a pen pal?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **A painting thought to be worth over 100-thousand pounds has been uncovered on the BBC's 'Fake or Fortune' programme.**

The 'enormously important' artwork is by the 18th-century Scottish artist Katherine Read. It's a fantastic discovery for the art world!

ON AIR – Have you ever found a hidden gem that turned out to be valuable? Or perhaps you've been on the show yourself?

TV · THIS WEEK

3 **There's a fascinating story about a pop band who went from playing for rescue dogs to selling out huge arenas!**

The group has been discussing their journey, including some disastrous early gigs, and how they put political action into their 'queer pop' music. What an incredible rise to fame!

ON AIR – What's the most unusual place you've ever seen a band play?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

4 **Charli XCX's new album, 'Music, Fashion, Film', is out and it's getting a lot of buzz.**

The star's latest work reportedly strips away the usual artifice to examine her life after the phenomenal success of her previous album, 'Brat'. Sounds like a deep dive into her world!

ON AIR – Are you a fan of Charli XCX? What are you hoping to hear on her new album?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

5 **EA Sports FC, the popular football game, has received a new age rating due to changes in rules around 'loot boxes'.**

The game's 'Ultimate Team' mode has now earned it a 16+ rating from the age ratings board PEGI. It's a sign of how gaming is evolving.

ON AIR – Do you think these changes to age ratings for games are a good thing?

GAMING · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

- 1 McLaren's Lando Norris has secured his first Grand Prix pole position of the year in Hungary!**
 He beat Lewis Hamilton with a brilliant final lap of the session, setting himself up perfectly for tomorrow's race. Could this be his day for a win?
ON AIR – Do you think Lando Norris can convert this pole position into a victory in Hungary?
 F1 · UK
- 2 Adil Rashid has turned the game on its head in The Hundred, taking three wickets in just five balls!**
 His Southern Brave side were struggling as Sunrisers Leeds went from 111-0 to 112-3. What a spell of bowling to get his team back into the match!
ON AIR – Have you ever seen a cricket match turn around so quickly with one incredible spell?
 CRICKET · UK
- 3 Boxing fans are eagerly anticipating the heavyweight fight between Anthony Joshua and Kristian Prenga this weekend.**
 Figures from the boxing world are giving their predictions for Saturday's big bout. Who do you think will come out on top?
ON AIR – Who are you backing in the Joshua versus Prenga fight? Is it going to be a classic?
 BOXING · UK
- 4 England's netball team has started their Commonwealth Games campaign with a comprehensive victory over Northern Ireland.**
 They thrashed their opponents 83-34 in Glasgow, showing they mean business right from the start. A fantastic opening performance!
ON AIR – How far do you think England can go in the netball at the Commonwealth Games this year?
 NETBALL · UK
- 5 Tottenham Hotspur manager Roberto de Zerbi has stated that any unhappy players should leave the club.**
 He says players who are not 'proud and happy to stay' should move on. Strong words from the gaffer!
ON AIR – Do you agree with Roberto de Zerbi's tough stance on players who aren't happy at the club?
 FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that a dose of 'awe' can significantly boost our well-being.**
Researchers found that experiencing moments of wonder, whether from nature or art, can make us feel more connected and generous. So, next time you see a stunning sunset, take a moment to soak it in!
- 2 The joy of 'tabletop gaming' is experiencing a big resurgence, bringing families and friends together for offline fun.**
Beyond classic board games, modern tabletop games offer intricate stories and collaborative play, providing a fantastic way to unplug and connect face-to-face.
- 3 Experts are highlighting the benefits of 'digital detoxes', encouraging us to regularly step away from screens.**
Even short breaks from devices can improve sleep, reduce stress, and enhance real-world interactions. Perhaps a screen-free Sunday is in order?
- 4 The simple act of 'doodling' is being recognised for its surprising cognitive benefits.**
Far from a distraction, studies show that doodling can actually help with concentration and memory retention. So, feel free to let your pen wander during those long meetings!
- 5 There's a growing trend for 'outdoor cinemas' this summer, offering a magical twist on movie night.**
Imagine watching your favourite film under the stars with a blanket and a picnic – it's becoming a popular way to enjoy entertainment with a difference.
- 6 Scientists have found that looking at 'patterns in nature', like fractals in ferns or coastlines, can actually reduce stress.**
It seems our brains find these naturally occurring geometric patterns inherently soothing. Another great reason to get outdoors!
- 7 The charm of 'letter writing' is making a quiet comeback, offering a personal touch in our digital age.**
Sending and receiving a handwritten letter feels wonderfully special and creates a lasting memento. Who will you write to this week?

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to reach something just out of grasp, even though we know it might not work?

ANSWER: STICKING THEIR TONGUE OUT, FOR EXTRA 'REACH'!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a nice, hot bowl of soup. What is it?

ANSWER: BLOW ON THE FIRST SPOONFUL, EVEN IF IT'S ALREADY LUKEWARM!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you hear a 'sound' that you haven't heard in ages, and it suddenly brings back a flood of memories?

What's a sound that instantly transports you back to a specific time or place, and what memory does it bring with it?

- We all have those 'little everyday objects' that, for some reason, we just can't seem to part with, even if they're a bit worn or broken, don't we?

What's an everyday item you own that has surprising sentimental value, and what's the story behind it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of pugs is actually called a 'grumble'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, not their feet.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£67 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£67 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's oldest piece of chewing gum is over 9,000 years old and was found in Finland.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- The inventor of the Pringles can is buried in one.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.
- The 'richest' bird in the world is the kiwi, with its eggs being up to 20% of its body weight.
- It is illegal to own just one guinea pig in Switzerland because they are social animals and get lonely.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.

On this day

Day 207 of the year, 158 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Andrew of Phú Yên; Christian feast day: Anne and Joachim (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Bartolomea Capitanio; Christian feast day: Blessed Camilla Gentili. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Peter Hyams, American director, screenwriter, and cinematographer
- 1950 — Susan George, English actress and producer
- 1957 — Nana Visitor, American actress
- 1945 — Helen Mirren, English actress
- 1956 — Tim Tremlett, English cricketer and coach
- 1944 — Betty Davis, American singer-songwriter (died 2022)
- 1978 — Eve Myles, Welsh actress
- 1974 — Iron & Wine, American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1953 — Cold War: Fidel Castro leads an unsuccessful attack on the Moncada Barracks, thus beginning the Cuban Revolution. The movement took the name of the date: 26th of July Movement
- 1968 — Vietnam War: South Vietnamese opposition leader Trương Đình Dzu is sentenced to five years hard labor for advocating the formation of a coalition government as a way to move toward an end to the war.
- 1963 — Syncom 2, the world's first geosynchronous satellite, is launched from Cape Canaveral on a Delta B booster.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1953 — Arizona Governor John Howard Pyle orders an anti-polygamy law enforcement crackdown on residents of Short Creek, Arizona, which becomes known as the Short Creek raid.
- 1958 — Explorer program: Explorer 4 is launched.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1953 — Soldiers from the 2nd Battalion, Royal Australian Regiment repel a number of Chinese assaults against a key position known as The Hook during the Battle of the Samichon River, just hours before the Armistice Agreement is signed, ending the Korean War.

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- 1974 — Greek Prime Minister Konstantinos Karamanlis forms the country's first civil government after seven years of military rule.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 208 of the year, 157 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anthusa of Mantinea; Christian feast day: Aurelius and Natalia and companions of the Martyrs of Córdoba.; Christian feast day: Blessed Maria Maddalena Martinengo; Christian feast day: Maurus, Pantalemon, and Sergius. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1968 — Julian McMahon, Australian actor and producer (died 2025)
- 1967 — Neil Smith, English cricketer
- 1946 — Peter Reading, English poet and author (died 2011)
- 1947 — Betty Thomas, American actress, director, and producer
- 1972 — Maya Rudolph, American actress and comedian
- 1977 — Jonathan Rhys Meyers, Irish actor
- 1984 — Kenny Wormald, American actor, dancer, and choreographer
- 1967 — Juliana Hatfield, American singer-songwriter and musician

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1955 — The Austrian State Treaty restores Austrian sovereignty.
- 2015 — Seven people are killed and many injured after gunmen attack an Indian police station in Punjab.
- 1964 — Vietnam War: Five thousand more American military advisers are sent to South Vietnam bringing the total number of United States forces in Vietnam to 21,000.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1995 — The Korean War Veterans Memorial is dedicated in Washington, D.C.
- 1955 — El Al Flight 402 is shot down by two fighter jets after straying into Bulgarian air space. All 58 people on board are killed.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 31 Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7 Once Upon a Time in a Cinema

FRI 14 Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie

FRI 21 Mutiny; The Bride!

FRI 28 Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4 Conjuring: Last Rites

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)